

CAREER PATHS

Once qualified, systems analysts can specialize in a particular type of computer system, such as an accounting or health-care system. If they work for a big company, they may be able to move into management or a strategic planning role.

TRAINEE After graduating high school, you can become a trainee IT technician while studying part-time or via distance learning for a relevant degree.

GRADUATE To become a systems analyst, you need a degree in computer science, mathematics, business studies, or a related area.



SYSTEMS ANALYST

Analysts work closely with business managers to develop effective IT systems. As an analyst, you may recommend and install new hardware or software, test the system, and teach staff how to use it. With experience, you may choose to specialize.



SKILLS GUIDE



Good team-working skills, and the ability to work with people in all parts of a company.



Strong leadership skills to motivate technicians, instruct developers, and influence managers.



An analytical and logical approach to designing and testing complex systems.

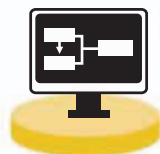


Highly developed IT skills across a wide range of hardware, software, and networks.



Sound commercial awareness to provide clients with cost-effective system solutions.

SENIOR ANALYST Heads up a team of IT professionals or takes on a management role, advising the directors of a company on IT strategy, such as implementing the use of databases.



TECHNICAL ARCHITECT

Makes decisions about the types of hardware and software products to be used. A technical architect is sometimes called a systems designer.



IT SYSTEMS PROJECT MANAGER

Oversees an IT project from start to finish. You will develop plans, manage teams, study risks, and track project budgets.



SOFTWARE ANALYST

Diagnoses problems with business software. May develop and write code for new applications when necessary.



IT CONSULTANT

Provides advice on IT matters to a range of businesses and government bodies for a management consultancy firm.